Templates.

For the people already in your network who you have never actually spoken to.

BUILT FOR

Anyone sitting on hundreds of connections they have never used, coming back after a long silence, or restarting a thread that went dead.

The method.

01 Acknowledge

Name the gap out loud. Two years of silence, a message you never answered, a request you accepted and forgot. Saying it directly removes the awkwardness. Pretending it is not there is exactly what makes these messages read as insincere.

02 Anchor

Give a specific reason you are messaging now, today. Their new role, your new role, something they shipped, a market shift. Without an anchor the message is just a person appearing for no reason, which is the thing that makes people not reply.

03 Ask

One thing, answerable in a line. A question they can respond to without opening a calendar. You are not trying to book a meeting on message one, you are trying to restart a conversation. The meeting comes two messages later, once a thread exists.

> **ASKS THAT GET ANSWERED**
>
> Are you still working on [the thing they mentioned]?
>
> Is that still the kind of brief you are working on?
>
> Are you running that in-house or working with someone external?
>
> Is it as good as it looks from out here?
>
> How is it going so far, and what pulled you across?

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

Most people get step three wrong. They open with a fifteen minute call request, which is a real commitment from someone who does not know them well. The honest answer is no and the easy answer is no reply. Ask something answerable in one line instead and the reply rate changes completely.

01. The cold connection

When: Connected two or more years ago, never spoken. Your largest bucket.

> Hi [Name], we connected a while back and I do not think we ever actually spoke. I am [one line on what you do now] and currently [specific goal]. Your work at [company] is directly relevant to that. Would you be open to a short call?

FILL IN

↳ [specific goal]: “looking at roles in X” beats “exploring opportunities”
↳ [one line on what you do now]: current role plus one concrete thing you have done

WHY IT WORKS

The acknowledgement does the heavy lifting. You are not pretending to be old friends, which is what makes cold reactivation cringe.

02. You messaged them, they never replied

When: You reached out months ago. Silence. You want to try again.

> Hi [Name], I reached out a while back and I know inboxes get away from all of us. Trying again because [reason that is new since last time]. [One line ask].

FILL IN

↳ [reason that is new]: their new role, your new role, something they shipped since

WHY IT WORKS

You reference the previous attempt without guilting them. The new reason is the critical part. Sending the same message twice teaches them to ignore you.

DON'T

Say “following up on my last message.” It reads as a complaint.

03. The recruiter who is likely hiring

When: Recruiter, connected recently, active in your space.

> Hi [Name], I saw you are recruiting across [specific space]. I am [one line on you, with one concrete win]. I am actively looking at [role type] roles in [industry] at the moment. Is that still the kind of brief you are working on?

FILL IN

↳ [specific space]: their actual patch, not “marketing”
↳ [one concrete win]: a number, a launch, a named brand

WHY IT WORKS

Recruiters scan for fit in seconds, so the concrete win has to be in the first message. The closing question is answerable in one word, and a yes almost always comes back with “what are you looking for,” which is them inviting the pitch instead of you volunteering it.

04. The cold recruiter

When: Recruiter connected two or more years ago. Never spoken.

> Hi [Name], we connected back when I was at [old company] and never actually spoke. Since then I have [what changed, one line]. I am now looking at [role type] roles in [industry]. Are you still covering that space, or has your focus shifted?

FILL IN

↳ [old company]: the memory hook, and the reason the gap makes sense

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WHY IT WORKS

The old context is the anchor. It explains the gap and gives them a memory hook. Offering “or has your focus shifted” makes it easy for them to reply honestly rather than ignore you, which keeps the door open for later.

ON THE ONES WITH NO REASON

If you cannot name a reason you are messaging someone, do not message them. A message with no anchor reads as exactly that, and it costs you the connection for the day you actually do have a reason. Sort your list, find the ones where something has changed, and leave the rest alone.

05. Someone at a company you want to work at

When: They work there. Not a recruiter, not hiring you directly.

> Hi [Name], I have been watching what [company] has been doing with [specific dated thing] and it is genuinely one of the more interesting things happening in [industry] right now. I am [one line on you]. Before I look at this properly, I would rather hear it from someone inside than from a careers page. Is it as good as it looks from out here?

FILL IN

↳ [specific dated thing]: a launch, an expansion, a decision. Something with a date on it.

WHY IT WORKS

You are asking for their opinion, not their time or a referral. People answer opinion questions because they are flattering and cost nothing. The intel you get back is better than any job description, and you now have a thread.

DON'T

Ask whether they are hiring in the first message. It converts a conversation into a transaction and usually ends it.

06. The founder or decision maker

When: You want them as a client.

> Hi [Name], I work with [industry] brands on [what you do], and watching [company] do [specific dated thing] made me curious about how you are handling [the relevant function]. Are you running that in-house at the moment or working with someone external?

FILL IN

↳ [the relevant function]: the specific thing you would take off their plate

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WHY IT WORKS

It qualifies them and starts a conversation in the same line. Founders delete anything that opens with your credentials, but they will answer a direct question about their own operation. Their answer also tells you immediately whether to keep going.

DON'T

Attach anything. A deck in message one signals you are running a volume play.

07. They changed jobs or got promoted

When: Their title updated in the last two weeks.

> Hi [Name], saw the move to [new company]. Congratulations, that is a big one. [One genuine line about why the move or the company is interesting]. How is it going so far, and what pulled you across?

FILL IN

↳ [one genuine line]: not flattery. An actual observation about the company or the move.

WHY IT WORKS

A role change is the only re-entry point that needs no justification at all. Asking what pulled them across is a question people enjoy answering because it lets them tell the story. It expires quickly though, so this is a two week window.

08. Same city, never met

When: Both in the same city, connected for years, zero contact.

> Hi [Name], we have been connected for [timeframe] and I have only just clocked that we have both been in [city] this entire time. I am [one line on what you are doing there now]. Feels like a miss. Would you want to grab coffee at some point? I have been meaning to try [some viral coffee spot].

FILL IN

↳ [viral coffee spot]: an actual place. It gives them somewhere to say yes to.

WHY IT WORKS

The realisation framing is honest and slightly funny, which is why it lands. Naming a specific place turns a vague coffee invite into a real plan, and specific plans get specific answers.

09. The warm contact you now need something from

When: You have spoken in the last few months. Now you want a favour.

> Hi [Name], good timing on our last conversation. I am about to [specific thing you are doing] and you came to mind because [specific, genuine reason]. No urgency at all, but would you be open to [one clear, small ask]?

FILL IN

↳ [specific reason]: why them and not somebody else. This is the whole message.

WHY IT WORKS

Naming why they specifically came to mind is what separates this from a mass message, and it is the part people skip. Warm relationships break when a vague message arrives with a hard ask attached.

DON'T

Stack two asks. If you need an intro and feedback, pick the one that matters and ask for the other later.

Before you send.

Circle back and **touch base** corporate filler, says nothing.

Pick your brain undervalues their time and everyone knows it.

Synergy instant delete.

Opportunity vague enough to mean anything, so it means nothing.

I hope this finds you well autopilot, and they can tell.

Just checking in needy with no intent attached.

Reaching out to see if padding before the actual sentence.

ON TIMING

Send within a day or two of whatever you are referencing. If your anchor is a post from three weeks ago it has already stopped feeling specific. If the signal is old, find a newer one or wait for the next.

Start with the one you have been putting off the longest.